



GAMING FOR FREE

Games and free! Two words that seem to be used together nowadays with increasing frequency. It is easier and cheaper now to make games than it ever has been before, and the end result is that there are a plethora of Indie games developed out of love and passion that are available for free.

Don't take this to mean that free games are a new concept, by no stretch of the imagination! Many popular titles such as Doom and Quake were distributed for free, as shareware, a term now lost in history. These games were distributed with a limited level set so players could play a good chunk of the game — often hours of gameplay — for free, and could purchase the rest if they wanted.

This might seem like the concept of game demos as it exists today, but shareware was more than that. It is a rare demo today that gives more than